Section 2. **Declaration of Policy.** It is the policy of the Provincial Government of Zamboanga Sibugay to promote animal welfare and protect animals from cruelty, abuse, neglect, and exploitation. This Ordinance upholds the principles of the Animal Welfare Act (RA 8485, as amended by RA 10631) and affirms the province's responsibility to prevent animal cruelty, regulate treatment of animals, and raise awareness of humane care.

Section 3. **Objectives.** This Ordinance aims to:

a.) Prohibit horse fighting within the province of Zamboanga Sibugay;
b.) Impose appropriate local penalties consistent with the Local Government Code;
c.) Establish enforcement mechanisms in coordination with national agencies; and
d.) Promote public awareness and livelihood alternatives that do not involve animal cruelty.

Section 4. **Definition of Terms.** For purposes of this Ordinance, the following terms shall be defined as follows:

- Horse fighting – an event wherein horses are intentionally made to fight for public entertainment, gambling, or any other purpose;
- Engaging in horse fighting – participating, organizing, sponsoring, or betting in a horse-fight activity;
- Organizer – an individual or group that coordinates or stages a horse fight for entertainment or gain;
- Bettor – a person who risks money or property on the outcome of a horse fight;
- Spectator – one who knowingly attends and witnesses horse fighting;
- Sponsor – a person, business, or entity that financially supports a horse-fighting event;
- Venue – any public or private place where horse fighting or other animal fights are held.

ARTICLE II – SCOPE AND COVERAGE

Section 5. **Coverage.** This Ordinance covers all persons, natural or juridical, events, venues, activities, wagers, and other acts directly or indirectly related to horse fighting or other animal fights within Zamboanga Sibugay.

ARTICLE III – PROHIBITED ACTS

Section 6. **Prohibited Acts.** It shall be unlawful within the Province of Zamboanga Sibugay to:

a.) Organize, promote, host, finance, or facilitate horse fights;
b.) Own, train, sell, or transport any horse for fighting purposes;
c.) Attend, bet on, or otherwise participate in horse-fighting events;
d.) Use any property or facility as a venue for horse fighting;
e.) Advertise, broadcast, or livestream horse-fighting events; or
f.) Conceal or harbor persons or animals involved in such activities after official notice.

ARTICLE IV – PENALTIES, FINES AND SANCTIONS

Section 7. Local Penalties and Administrative Sanctions

a.) Any person, natural or juridical, who violates any provision of this Ordinance shall, upon conviction, be punished by a fine of Five Thousand Pesos (₱ 5,000.00) and/or imprisonment of not more than one (1) year, at the discretion of the court. This is without prejudice to the filing of appropriate criminal charges under Republic Act No. 8485, otherwise known as the Animal Welfare Act of 1998, as amended by Republic Act No. 10631, and other applicable national laws.

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